Your speaker guide

90-minute session · Supplied notes for 24 core slides and four backups. The route includes all eight complete activities within the 90-minute session.

Preparation

Open the webdeck and companion. Keep the workbook and two-page takeaways ready. Prepared teaching examples replace live model calls. Keep the one-page route beside the deck. All displayed practice data and responses are fictional.

01. TRUST, TRANSPARENCY, AND AI

Our session runs from 3:30 to 5:00 PM. The route integrates the slides and eight activities. All cases, records, operational constraints, and prepared drafts are fictional teaching examples. No participant needs an AI account. Generated illustrations depict fictional situations.

Welcome. Today covers both sides of the desk: AI supporting a scholarship team and AI supporting an applicant. Both raise the same question: how do we protect fairness and the trust of students? We will work through prompts, three prepared demonstrations, applicant AI use and practical policy. Our timed route includes explanations, eight activities and transitions. The four backup slides are optional.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/review-team.png

02. A quick pulse

Five-minute activity. Read the short scenario. Invite the provider and applicant perspectives without asking for personal disclosures. Debrief the relationship between a proposed change and a specific need; there is no single approved phrase.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: The trust I want our process to earn. Participant work to keep: My quality of trust; one change our team could make; why it matters.

03. Our two perspectives on the same review

Use this visual to compare needs, not to ask an unexplained question. A scholarship team needs a manageable workload, consistent rules and evidence it can explain. From an applicant’s perspective, the needs include knowing the rules, accurate representation and a correction route. Ask participants to use the Trust activity in the companion to propose one improvement and explain whose need it addresses.

04. Our guiding principle

If you remember one sentence, make it this one. AI can sort, summarize and suggest. People decide. Privacy concerns what information enters the system. Transparency concerns what applicants and staff understand about its use. Human oversight means a person has the time, authority and evidence to correct the work. Fairness means we test the process and apply the published criteria consistently. These are practical checkpoints. We will use them to evaluate each demonstration.

05. Vague and structured prompts

A vague prompt leaves the system to guess the criteria, scale and meaning of a strong response. A structured prompt makes the task inspectable. It still cannot guarantee accuracy or fairness. Compare the two requests and ask what the first leaves unsaid. Criteria, evidence requirements and decision boundaries belong in the instruction, so reviewers can check whether the response followed them.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/infographics/comparison.png

06. My six-part review request

Six-minute activity. Walk through the six labeled examples before participants adapt anything. Distinguish directions inside the AI prompt from directions for participants. Ask a pair to explain one edit and how a staff member would check the result.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: My six-part review request. Participant work to keep: My changed prompt part; why I changed it; what our intake coordinator must verify before acting.

07. The score descriptions I am using

The term reviewers means the scholarship team applying the rubric, including participants and their partners during the activity. Read the four descriptions before assigning a rating. If two reviewers interpret a score description differently, ask each to explain the exact words behind the judgment, then clarify the adopted rubric before real review. The repair-table paragraph on slide 11 is the material used in this activity; there is no missing longer essay.

08. The review workflow

Read the full sequence: intake; redact and minimize; completeness check; rubric pre-score with evidence; human review; committee decision; audit sample. AI can help at bounded drafting stages. A person approves the input, checks the evidence and owns the decision. Keep a record of the prompt version, corrections and reviewer. The final audit compares AI-assisted work with the source and independent human judgment. Repeat our principle: AI can sort, summarize and suggest. People decide.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/conversation/workflow-wide.png

09. Privacy before processing

Before any real applicant data enters a tool, obtain local approval for the actual service, settings and purpose. An account label alone does not establish privacy. Removing a name may leave enough details to identify someone. For this workshop, use fictional records only. Check the privacy notice and donor agreements, and ask the appropriate owners which laws apply. FERPA does not apply identically to every independent scholarship provider or every record. Never upload confidential applicant records to an unapproved consumer service. Redaction alone does not make every use safe.

U.S. Department of Education, Privacy and Data Sharing: https://studentprivacy.ed.gov/privacy-and-data-sharing FERPA applicability and exceptions depend on the institution, records and disclosure; local owners must confirm applicable requirements.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/privacy-team.png

10. Demo 1 · Our document follow-up plan

Seven-minute activity. This is process design, not a hunt for an obvious missing-document label. Read the two-channel setup and the limited-time constraint. Ask pairs to compare workload, applicant burden, and consistent treatment. Do not supply a deadline or imply that a blank field establishes ineligibility.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: Our document follow-up plan. Participant work to keep: Our verification role; our trigger for applicant contact; our unresolved-case procedure; one trade-off.

11. Demo 2 · My rating and the words behind it

Eight-minute activity. The displayed paragraph is the material participants review; there is no missing longer essay. Model what a quotation is using the example already on the page. Protect independent judgment before discussing the draft 3. Debrief what the paragraph establishes and what it leaves open.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: My rating and the words behind it. Participant work to keep: My rating (1–4); exact words copied from E1; how those words fit the score description; what I still do not know.

12. Demo 3 · The evidence behind my summary

Six-minute activity. Give the definitions before asking participants to tag. The flawed summary is deliberately authored. Ask how an adjective or tag could change attention. Debrief preserving the applicant’s account rather than guessing character or eligibility.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: A summary that preserves the evidence. Participant work to keep: Our neutral summary (up to 60 words); tag and source words; uncertainty; how staff find the original record.

13. Our first tests before a pilot

This visual supports the matching activity in the companion. Read the slide’s first-person statement as the participant’s learning target. The companion contains the rules, source material, examples and response space.

14. Where AI fits

Eight-minute activity. Define meaningful human oversight as time, evidence, and authority. Ask groups to name roles rather than writing “human review.” Compare one realistic pause-and-resume procedure; avoid implying that a small sample certifies fairness.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: Our workflow and first test. Participant work to keep: Our workflow roles; first test; evidence to record; pause condition and the role who resolves it.

15. Applicant AI use spans a spectrum

Applicant AI use is not one uniform behavior. Spell-check, brainstorming, feedback and generating a full personal essay raise different questions. Ask partners where their organization would draw a boundary and what purpose that boundary serves. Avoid assuming the spectrum represents a universal ethical scale. Accessibility tools, translation support and human editing can overlap with AI features. The organization must publish understandable rules, examples and an accessible disclosure route before applicants invest time in writing.

16. Detection has practical limits

These are dated examples, not claims about every detector available today. OpenAI withdrew its particular classifier on July 20, 2023. Vanderbilt announced its decision on August 16, 2023. Editing and prompting reduced detection in the 2023 Liang study; performance depends on the system and sample. Turnitin's current guidance says the indicator can misidentify text and must not be the sole basis for adverse action. A report describes a tool's assessment of qualifying prose, not the probability that an applicant committed misconduct.

Sources: OpenAI historical classifier withdrawal, July 20, 2023: https://openai.com/index/new-ai-classifier-for-indicating-ai-written-text/

Vanderbilt historical decision, August 16, 2023: https://www.vanderbilt.edu/brightspace/2023/08/16/guidance-on-ai-detection-and-why-were-disabling-turnitins-ai-detector/

Turnitin, Using the AI Writing Report: warns against sole reliance for adverse action. https://guides.turnitin.com/hc/en-us/articles/22774058814093-Using-the-AI-Writing-Report

Liang et al. (2023), Patterns. Seven detectors, 91 TOEFL essays; average false-positive rate 61.3% in that sample. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2023.100779

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/infographics/policy.png

17. The human cost of a false positive

The arithmetic assumes all five thousand submissions are human-written and an illustrative one-percent false-positive rate: the expected count is fifty. It is not an observed rate, a forecast for this organization or the chance that a flagged person is innocent. Liang and colleagues found a 61.3% average false-positive rate across seven detectors on 91 TOEFL essays in their 2023 study. That study provides evidence of a disparity in those samples and tools, not a universal current rate. A 2026 Czech-language study found no systematic bias in its tested detector families. Different samples can produce different findings. Avoid unsupported claims about neurodivergent writers.

Sources: Liang et al. (2023), Patterns. Seven detectors, 91 TOEFL essays; average false-positive rate 61.3% in that sample. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2023.100779

Al Ali et al. (2026), Czech-language study; found no systematic bias against non-native writers in its tested detector families. Findings cannot be generalized across all languages or tools. https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.05769

18. Application design for authenticity

Ask for a specific experience, the applicant’s contribution and the evidence of what happened. A follow-up conversation can clarify an account, but it does not prove authorship and must allow reasonable access and accommodations. Use the same process for similarly situated finalists. A brief optional reflection can describe writing support without turning disclosure into a penalty. Corroborate important claims through appropriate records or references. These practices support a richer review; none makes an application immune to fabrication.

VISUAL SOURCES: https://mguhlin.github.io/nspa/2026/images/photorealistic/applicant.png

19. A finalist’s essay feels “too perfect”

Twelve-minute activity. The rule is supplied so participants can actually apply it. Do not introduce a new translation disclosure requirement. A conclusion that no misconduct inquiry is justified is legitimate. Debrief both applicant expectations and verified provider transparency.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: Applicant rules and a fair response. Participant work to keep: The rule and facts supporting our action; our response or staff note; our provider-use statement and correction contact.

20. The applicant AI rule my organization chooses

The four illustrated approaches are policy choices, not a ranking of ethical quality. A prohibition needs scope and accessibility exceptions. Disclosure needs a short, usable statement and an explanation of how it affects review. Bounded use needs permitted and prohibited examples. Embrace still requires truthful claims and examination of substance. The supplied practice rule in the companion combines bounded use with disclosure.

21. Transparency goes both ways

We cannot reasonably ask applicants to explain their AI assistance while leaving our own process obscure. The sample statement is a starting point, not a description of an existing organization. Confirm the service, data use, retention and training arrangements before publishing any promise. If the organization can substantiate that applicant data is never used for model training, it can state that clearly. Do not add that assurance merely because the account is paid. Explain how a human verifies the output and how an applicant can seek a correction or review.

22. The three gaps I will work on first

The complete twelve-item checklist is in the companion. The slide groups it into tools and data, evidence and review, and rules and transparency. Ask participants to choose three gaps without promising to fix everything at once. The final activity turns a priority into a 30 / 60 / 90-day plan.

23. A 30 / 60 / 90-day plan

Eight-minute activity. Protect the closing time. Ask for a small clerical task and a concrete next action, not a promise to adopt AI. Allow stopping or revising as a valid outcome. Close by returning to the trust qualities participants named at the start.

The companion and workbook contain all of the case information, examples and response prompts for this activity. Activity: My 30 / 60 / 90-day plan. Participant work to keep: My task and owner; steps for 30, 60, and 90 days; review date; evidence of improvement; pause condition.

24. Back to trust

Every scholarship carries trust: donors entrust their intent to the provider, and applicants entrust their stories to the process. AI may help reduce administrative work, but a person remains responsible for the evidence, the treatment of the applicant and the final decision. Invite one change participants will try with a colleague and when they will review it. The complete activities and participant downloads are on the website. The four following slides are backups for questions and practice.

25. B1 · Three complete demo prompts

Backup outside the timed ninety-minute route. These are full reusable practice prompts, not a guarantee of output quality. Put authorized rules and input evidence in clearly separated sections. Replace bracketed fields with approved criteria and fictional packets. Include stable paragraph identifiers so quotations can be traced. Keep the same prompt version and settings during comparisons. If a tool cannot support a requested format or reliable source tracing, pause and use a manual process. Read the generated response against the application before discussing it as a useful example.

26. B2 · Questions for an AI vendor

Backup. Ask for written answers tied to the service edition and contract you would actually use. Training controls and retention controls are different. A no-training term does not automatically mean zero retention or no human access. Identify subprocessors, access controls, incident procedures and deletion mechanisms. Ask how model or service changes are communicated. Local privacy, security and program owners should decide whether the purpose, data and settings are appropriate. Preserve evidence of the approval and review it when the service or use changes.

27. B3 · A simple applicant disclosure

Backup. This form is a sample rather than an existing organizational policy. Add a direct link to the permitted and prohibited examples. Explain whether disclosure affects review and give applicants a route to ask about accessibility and translation tools. Do not ask for complete chat histories or unnecessary personal information by default. An applicant should not have to guess which features count. Use a brief acknowledgment about factual accuracy and compliance with the published rule. Test the language with students before the application cycle opens.

28. B4 · A shared vocabulary

Backup. A shared vocabulary helps a team discuss a problem precisely. An LLM can generate fluent text without verifying the truth of its claims. Hallucination includes fabricated quotations as well as incorrect summaries. A false positive concerns a human text flagged by a detector; it is different from a false claim produced by a review assistant. Personal information can remain in an essay after names are removed because details can identify someone in combination. Human in the loop must describe actual authority, time and evidence for review. Simply clicking approve is not meaningful oversight.